Jan Markmann

Tech Lead / Team Lead

Experienced software tech lead and team lead specializing in backend engineering with PHP/Symfony and cloud-native DevOps platforms. Builds end-to-end engineering across architecture, delivery, and operations: maintainable codebases, automated tests, repeatable deployments, and stable production systems. Currently Tech Lead in the Roaming domain (EV charging), owning the technical scope across roaming topics and contributing to the implementation of the OCPI protocol in a Kotlin/PHP environment. Combines deep hands-on expertise with leadership experience in cross-functional teams, both as a tech lead and in disciplinary people leadership. Focus on clear technical communication, pragmatic decisions, strong quality, and sustainable team processes.

Experience

Tech Lead; previously Team Lead; previously Senior Software Engineer & People Lead

Jul 2022 - Present

chargecloud GmbH

Cologne (remote)

Owned DevOps, IT, and SysOps with a focus on automation and information security. Led a team of up to 8 and coordinated external providers. Designed and operated container and Kubernetes platforms including CI/CD and infrastructure automation (GitLab, TeamCity, Ansible). Since 2025-11: Tech Lead in the Roaming domain, owning the technical scope across roaming topics and implementing the OCPI protocol.

- Led security hardening of internal APIs across roaming services.
- Improved OCPI interoperability by adding previously missing spec requirements across Locations, Credentials, Connections, and Version modules.
- Led a DevOps/IT/SysOps team (up to 8) with technical and disciplinary responsibility, including coaching and stakeholder management.
- Established incident management and monitored SLA-relevant systems (availability, resources, alerting).
- Co-owned information security topics, including policies and compliance-adjacent processes, and coordinated external providers.
- Designed, migrated, and operated Docker stacks and Kubernetes/Helm setups and documented the target architecture.
- Built and improved CI/CD with GitLab and TeamCity and ensured release and deployment processes reliability.
- Improved release transparency and CI/CD traceability.
- Streamlined container builds.
- Stabilized payment processing.
- Tech: PHP 7.4 - 8.5, Symfony 5.2 - 8.5, OCPI, Docker, Helm, Kubernetes, Ansible, Caddy, GitLab, Renovate, TeamCity, MariaDB, Harbor, Backstage, Uptime Kuma, Linux

Senior Software Developer

Jan 2021 - Jun 2022

Digital Control GmbH & Co. KG

Dusseldorf (remote)

Worked on components in a Kubernetes-based microservice architecture. Focus areas: object storage (S3/MinIO), document generation, and observability.

- Implemented multi-tenant S3 storage provisioning, controlling Kubernetes cluster/MinIO from Symfony.
- Built a PDF document generator for product data sheets within an e-commerce microservice architecture.
- Built a Grafana setup using Graylog data and monitored reliability metrics.
- Tech: PHP 7, Symfony, Docker, Google Cloud Run, Kubernetes, MinIO, Rancher, GitLab, InfluxDB, Grafana, Graylog

Software Developer, Consultant & Interim Head of IT

Mar 2020 - Jan 2021

Self-employed

Cologne

Interim head of IT and consultant focused on IT/DevOps tooling and processes, hiring support, and infrastructure consolidation. Took over and operated Shopware 6 hosting on AWS.

- Interim head of IT and support in recruiting (IT lead SysOps/Dev).
- Set up development and DevOps tooling for a junior Shopware team (Docker, GitLab CI, review apps).
- API work and integrations (REST/GraphQL) including MongoDB.
- Took over and operated Shopware 6 hosting on AWS (EC2).
- Consolidated and standardized local and external IT infrastructure.
- Tech: PHP 7, Shopware, Symfony, AWS, Caddy, Docker, GitLab/GitHub, MongoDB, Linux

Senior Software Developer

May 2019 - Mar 2020

Graph-IT GmbH

Cologne

Worked on an internal graph-based database system with a focus on data and process modeling. Also delivered industrial automation prototypes with Raspberry Pi and Python.

- Enhanced the internal graph database system (backend and domain model).
- Built and maintained APIs and integrations (GraphQL).
- Data and process modeling within the graph-based system; implemented process flows.
- Industrial automation prototyping with Raspberry Pi and Python (async) incl. fieldbus (Modbus/RS-485).
- Tech: GraphQL, PHP 7, Python (async), Symfony, GitLab, Modbus/RS-485

Software Developer & Consultant

May 2017 - Apr 2019

Freiberuflich

Cologne

Freelance work in agency and enterprise environments, including e-commerce and DevOps. Focus: Symfony/PHP, integrations, and service-oriented architectures.

- Set up DevOps tooling and improved CI/CD in project teams.
- Supported delivery and quality assurance in an enterprise client project team within an agency setup.
- Enhanced internal applications for sales and process control.
- Spryker development and customization.
- Built REST APIs to connect satellite projects, including data export to an ERP system.
- Tech: Doctrine, PHP 7, PHPUnit, Spryker, Symfony 3.x, GitLab, MySQL, PostgreSQL, RabbitMQ, Redis, Propel

Team Lead Software Engineering

Oct 2013 - Apr 2017

preis24.de GmbH

Dusseldorf

Led software engineering: maintained a legacy platform and designed and built a new service-oriented sales platform. Introduced agile practices and strengthened QA, CI, and DevOps standards.

- Technical and disciplinary leadership of the software engineering team.
- Introduced and evolved agile practices (Kanban, Scrum).
- Maintained and improved a legacy platform with a focus on stability and delivery.
- Designed and built a new service-oriented sales platform.
- Tech: Doctrine, PHP 5, PHPUnit, REST/SOAP, Symfony2, GitHub, Travis CI, MongoDB, MySQL5, Redis, Jira, Zend Framework

Software Developer

Jul 2010 - Sep 2013

Questback

Cologne

Maintained and extended an enterprise feedback suite and developed new components. Also built a social media monitoring application.

- Developed new product components and modules.
- Built a social media monitoring application including API integrations.

- Implemented web services (JSON-RPC, SOAP) and integrations.
- Maintained and extended the Enterprise Feedback Suite.
- Tech: PHP 5, Symfony Components, Hudson/Jenkins, Social Media APIs, MySQL5, Assetic, Zend Framework

Software Developer and Consultant

Oct 2009 - Jul 2010

Freiberuflich

Freelance project work as software developer and consultant focused on PHP/MySQL and symfony 1.3–1.4.

- Project work as software developer and consultant.
- Tech: Java, PHP5, symfony 1.3–1.4, MySQL, Eclipse/OSGI, ezComponents, Linux, Smarty, Typo3, UML

Senior Software Developer / Team Lead

Oct 2008 - Oct 2009

silversurfer7 GmbH

Cologne

Senior engineering and team leadership in an agency environment, focusing on portal and platform development in cross-functional teams.

- Team and development lead in agency web projects.
- Built portals for the tourism industry.
- Built a product catalog for providers of security and surveillance technology.
- Tech: PHP 5, Symfony, MySQL5, Internet-Booking-Engines, Propel, Zend Lucene Search

Software Developer

Feb 2008 - Oct 2008

best webnews GmbH

Cologne

Worked on a news aggregation portal, enriching content with metadata (including geographic data) and delivering partner integrations.

- Built and enhanced a news portal for aggregation and presentation.
- Implemented metadata enrichment (notably geographic) and partner embedding.
- Tech: CakePHP, PHP 5, MySQL5, AJAX, Drupal, jQuery, Netvibes UWA

PHP Programmer

Jan 2006 - Jan 2008

Agentur Grintsch e.K.

Cologne

Software development for enterprise and mid-sized clients, including Epson Germany.

- Software development for enterprise and mid-sized clients, including Epson Germany.
- Built a printer leasing system.
- Built and maintained a product database.
- Tech: PHP 5, Symfony, MySQL5, Propel, Zend Lucene Search

Education

Cologne University of Applied Sciences (Campus Gummersbach)

Dec 2003 - Dec 2005

Diploma (no degree) in Business Information Systems

Oberberg Vocational College, Gummersbach

Dec 2000 - Dec 2003

State-certified IT Assistant, advanced technical college entrance qualification in Information Technology

Skills

Leadership

- Team leadership
- People management
- Team management
- Mentoring
- Team motivation

Software Architecture

- Service-oriented
- Microservices
- Data modeling
- Process modeling
- Migration strategies
- DDD

Software Design

- OOP
- Separation of concerns
- Clean Code
- S.O.L.I.D.
- Design patterns

PHP

- PHP 3.0 - 8.5
- composer
- PDO
- Propel
- FPDF/FPDI

Symfony

- Bundles
- DI Container
- API Platform
- Event Dispatcher
- Twig
- Flex

DevOps

- CI/CD
- GitLab CI
- Docker/Docker Compose
- Ansible
- Bash
- GNU Make
- TeamCity
- Hudson/Jenkins
- Travis CI
- Harbor
- Renovate

Cloud

- Kubernetes
- Helm
- Rancher
- AWS
- Google Cloud
- Digital Ocean
- Heroku
- Dokku
- K3s

IT Security

- ISO 27001
- ISMS
- Vulnerability Management
- Incident Response

Quality Assurance

- Automated tests
- PHPUnit
- Continuous integration
- Test-driven design

APIs & Web Services

- REST
- GraphQL
- OpenAPI/Swagger
- SOAP
- JSON-RPC

Static code analysis

Relational Databases

MySQL
MariaDB
PostgreSQL

NoSQL

MongoDB
Redis

Messaging

RabbitMQ
MQTT (Mosquitto)

Monitoring & Observability

Grafana
Sentry
InfluxDB
ELK
Graylog

Git

GitHub
GitLab
Bitbucket

Web Servers

Caddy
Apache
Nginx
Lighttpd

IDEs & Debugging

Visual Studio Code
PHPStorm
Eclipse
XDebug
Gitpod

Agile Methods

Scrum
Kanban

Analysis

Object-oriented analysis
Requirements analysis
Reverse Engineering

Collaboration & Project Management

Jira
Slack
Wiki
Confluence
Asana
monday.com
miro

Operating Systems

Linux (Ubuntu)
DOS
Windows 95 to 7

Virtualization

LXC
Virtualbox
VMWare

Other Programming Languages

Java
C#
C / C++
HTML / CSS
Python
poetry
async

Other Version Control Systems

Mercurial
Subversion
CVS

Doctrine

ORM ODM

Languages

German — Native English — Fluent

Interests

Mountain biking

Trails, Dirt, Slopestyle

Music

Piano, Harmonica, Blues, Boogie Woogie

Smart Home

OpenHAB, Homematic, Amazon Echo, ESP 8266

Baking